

Build Steps

Cowork is task-driven — give Copilot a job, optionally schedule it, let it use your M365.

1 Open Copilot Cowork

Open Microsoft 365 Copilot and switch to Cowork mode (left rail). Confirm the surfaces you have available — Cowork can act on your behalf across:

- Outlook (read, summarise, draft, send, schedule)
- Teams (chats, channels, post messages, read history)
- Calendar (find times, create meetings, prep briefs)
- SharePoint & OneDrive (read files, write Word/Excel/PowerPoint to your files)
- Power BI (semantic models, reports, DAX queries)

2 Paste the Headline Task

Open a new Cowork task and paste the prompt below. This is the worked example for Technology — Incident Recap — adapt names, channels, and Power BI reports to your tenant before running.

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Every Monday at 7:00am, run the Incident Recap for last week:

1. Do NOT send/post automatically – leave the draft for me to review. Blameless rule: never name individuals – frame all language around systems, services, and teams.
2. Open Tech_Incidents_Data.xlsx from /Engineering/Incidents/. Read every row where StartUTC falls within the last 7 days. Filter to Severity SEV1 and SEV2 only, sort by StartUTC.
3. For each incident, capture: IncidentID, Service, Environment, Severity, StartUTC, DetectedUTC, ResolvedUTC, MTTRMinutes, RootCauseCategory, Summary, ActionItemsOpen, OwningTeam.
4. Compute Time-to-Detect (DetectedUTC – StartUTC) per incident. Flag any TTD > 15 minutes as 'detection gap'.
5. Cluster by RootCauseCategory across the last 30 days. Call out any category appearing 3+ times – recurring patterns worth a deeper postmortem.
6. Read the '#incidents' Teams channel for last week. Link each IncidentID to its bridge thread where one exists. Flag any SEV1/SEV2 with no bridge thread.
7. Build a Word recap saved to /Engineering/Weekly/Incidents_<week>.docx: SEV1/SEV2 table, MTTR distribution, detection gaps, recurring root-cause clusters, Open Action list grouped by OwningTeam.
8. Draft a Teams message to 'Engineering Leadership': counts by severity, MTTR median, top recurring root cause, link to the recap. Leave as draft.
9. For each OwningTeam with ActionItemsOpen older than 14 days, draft a short Teams DM to the lead with IncidentIDs and an 'update or close' ask. Leave drafts.
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3 Set the Schedule

In the task panel, choose Schedule and configure:

Frequency	Weekly
Run Time	Monday 07:00 (before engineering all-hands)
Execution Mode	Inline (recommended) — task remembers context across runs

4 Verify the First Run

Run once now (Run now) before scheduling kicks in. Confirm:

- Every SEV1 / SEV2 from last week is present — spot-check 3 against the workbook
- MTTR median matches a manual calc on the same filter
- Detection-gap flag fires at exactly TTD > 15 min, not 14 or 16
- Zero individual names in the recap; teams and services only

Try These Live

Copy any of these into a new Cowork task — one-shot or scheduled.

Single-Incident Postmortem

I'll paste an IncidentID. Pull the row, related Teams bridge thread, related emails, and any Power BI Engineering Health visuals from that window. Draft a blameless postmortem Word doc: timeline (detection, first response, mitigation, resolution), contributing factors, what worked, action items with OwningTeam.

MTTR Trend Read-Out

Every Friday at 4pm: read the workbook for the last 60 days. Plot MTTR by Severity and Service. Flag any Service whose MTTR has worsened by >20% versus the prior 60 days. Draft a Teams message to the Reliability channel with the table and 2 questions for owners. Leave as draft.

Detection-Gap Sweep

Across the last 30 days, list every incident where Time-to-Detect exceeded 15 minutes. Group by Service. Build a Word brief: services with repeated detection gaps, suggested instrumentation questions (no answers – questions). Email to the Observability lead. Leave draft.

Open-Action Reckoning

From the workbook, list every ActionItemsOpen older than 30 days. Group by OwningTeam. For each team, draft a short, neutral Teams DM to the lead with the list and a 'close / re-scope / escalate' ask. Leave drafts.

How to Think About This Teammate

Cowork replaces:

- Friday afternoon hand-built incident recaps
- Recurring root causes spotted only at quarter-end
- Stale action items lost in incident docs

With:

- ✓ A Monday 7am recap with MTTR and cluster signal
- ✓ Detection-gap flags grounded in StartUTC vs DetectedUTC
- ✓ Open actions chased blamelessly, by team

Not a chatbot. A scheduled teammate with full access to your M365.

Tip for real-world use

Blameless means the prompt says it. Pin into every task: 'Never name individuals. Use service names, team names, and system behaviour only.' Pair with strict evidence — cite IncidentID and StartUTC on every claim. Engineering leadership trusts what it can trace.

You've built a Cowork teammate ✓

You now have a Copilot teammate that can:

- Run Monday's incident recap automatically
- Catch recurring root causes by week 3, not Q4
- Spot detection gaps from the data, blamelessly
- Keep open actions visible until they close